O–P–553a
AUGUST 2, 1955

SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. O–P–00553 (Agr.)
October 20, 1954 and
Fed. Spec. O–P–553
November 10, 1947

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

POTASSIUM CHLORIDE (MURIATE OF POTASH); FOR FERTILIZER PURPOSES

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope.—This specification covers a commercial grade of potassium chloride suitable for fertilizer purposes.

1.2 Classification. — Potassium chloride for fertilizer purposes covered by this specification shall be furnished in one grade only (see 6.1).

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS AND OTHER PUBLICATION

2.1 Specifications. — There are no other specifications applicable to this specification except those referenced in section 7 by individual departments.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications and Standards as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D. C.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, Seattle, and Washington, D. C.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications and Standards and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

2.2 Other publication.—The following publication, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids, forms a part of this specification:

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Agricultural Chemists.

(The publication referenced above is published by the Association of Official Agricultural Chemists, Post Office Box 540, Benjamin Franklin Station, Washington 4, D. C.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Potash content (calculated as K_2O).— Potash content shall be not less than 60 percent water soluble, by weight, calculated in terms of K_2O.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Sampling.—A sample shall be taken as prescribed in the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Agricultural Chemists. Each sample shall consist of at least 1 pound of material, but preferably 2 pounds, taken in the following manner: Remove a core diagonally from end to end through bag lying horizontally. Take cores as follows: From lots of 1-10 bags, sample all bags; from lots of 11-20 bags, sample 10 bags; from lots of 21-40 bags, sample 15 bags; from lots of 41 or more bags, sample 20 bags. Take 1 core from each bag sampled, except that for lots of 1-4 bags take enough cores from each bag, following same course, to total 5 or more

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cores. For bulk fertilizer draw not less than 20 cores from different regions; in sampling fertilizer in small containers (10 pounds or less) 1 package will be sufficient. Thoroughly mix portions taken on clean oilcloth or paper, reduce by quartering to quantity of sample required, and place in clean, dry, air-tight container.

4.2 Inspection.—Each lot shall be inspected as to proper marking of bag, compliance with applicable State laws, condition of bag, and mechanical condition of fertilizer.

4.3 Tests. — Chemical and physical analysis of the fertilizer shall be conducted as prescribed in the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Agricultural Chemists.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging.—Unless otherwise specified, the subject commodity shall be packaged in substantial commercial containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, at the lowest rate, to the point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

5.2 Marking.

5.2.1 *Issue packages.*—Unless otherwise specified, issue packages shall be marked with the name of the item, the quantity contained therein, and the name of the manufacturer or contractor.

5.2.2 *Shipping containers.*—Unless otherwise specified, shipping containers shall be marked with the name of the item and the quantity contained therein as defined by the contract or order under which the shipment is made, the name of the contractor, and the number of the contract or order. In the case of bags, the name of the contractor and the contract or order number may appear on a suitable waterproof tag securely fastened thereto.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data.—Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein. (See 5.1 and 5.2.)

6.2 Potassium salts for fertilizer purposes are usually considered on a K_2O basis.

6.3 It is believed that this specification adequately describes the characteristics necessary to secure the desired material and that normally no samples will be necessary prior to award to determine compliance with this specification. If, for any particular purpose, samples with bids are necessary they should be specifically asked for in the invitation for bids, and the particular purpose to be served by the bid sample should be definitely stated, the specification to apply in all other respects.

6.4 Federal specifications do not include all types, classes, grades, sizes, etc., of the commodities indicated by the titles of the specifications, or which are commercially available, but are intended to cover the types, etc., which are suitable for Federal Government requirements.

6.5 Transportation description

6.5.1 *Transportation description applicable to this item is:*

Potassium chloride (muriate of potash)
Carload minimum weights:
In containers in barrels or boxes, 30,000 pounds.
In bulk in bags, barrels, boxes or steel pails, 40,000 pounds.
Truckload minimum weight 40,000 pounds.

Minimum weights shown apply when material is transported at Classification ratings. They will vary when material moves on commodity rates. When in doubt consult General Services Administration Regional Traffic Manager.

Patent notice.—The furnishing by the Government of specifications, including drawings or other data in connection therewith, does not in any way grant the recipient of such material, or any other person, a license or right to manufacture, use, or sell any patented or unpatented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

7. DEPARTMENTAL REQUIREMENTS

7.1 The following specification and standard, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, and special requirements, form a part of this specification for purchases made under this specification by the respective departments.

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7.2 Army, Navy, and Air Force.

7.2.1 *Applicable specification and standard.*

Federal Specification:

UU–S–48—Sacks, Paper, Shipping.

Military Standard:

MIL–STD–129—Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of specifications and standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring agency or as directed by the contracting officer.)

7.2.2 *Packing.*

7.2.2.1 *For domestic shipment, immediate use.*—Potassium chloride shall be packed in containers in accordance with the requirements as specified in 5.1.

7.2.2.2 *For domestic shipment and storage.*—Potassium chloride shall be packed in 80 pound or 100 pound multiwall paper bags, as specified in the contract or order, conforming to the requirements of style 5W and 10W of Federal Specification UU–S–48 respectively.

7.2.2.3 *For overseas shipment.* — Potassium chloride shall be packed in 80 pound or 100 pound multiwall paper bags, as specified in the contract or order, conforming to the requirements of style 9X and 14X of Federal Specification UU–S–48 respectively.

7.2.3 *Marking.* — In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, marking for shipment shall be in accordance with Military Standard MIL–STD–129.

MILITARY INTEREST:
Navy—Y

3

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